**Institution**: Penn Museum
**Registration Number**: E14368A-B
**Fabric**: Painted Nile silt ceramic
**Shape**: Ḥs (Hes)-vase shaped (Vessel for liquid libations)
**Attribution**: N/A
**Date**: 1353-1190 BCE (New Kingdom, Late Dynasty 18-Late Dynasty 19)
**Dimensions**: H. 93.5 cm; D. 25cm
**Provenance**: From Thebes or Amarna, Gift of Sophia Cadwalader in memory of Eckley B. Coxe Jr., 1926

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**Fabric, Technique, Shape & Condition**
Wheel-thrown Nile silt ceramic vessel of Ḥs-type, with a tall, slender body, high shoulder, narrow neck, and flaring rim. The exterior is decorated with polychrome bands in cobalt blue, outlined in red and black. The vessel is largely intact, with minor surface fading to the blue pigment. The body of the vessel shows red fire clouds, likely from kiln conditions when it was fired. There is also evidence of water damage on the surface. The rim has been cracked and restored; there also appears to be a seam on the lower part of the vessel where it has been repaired. No major structural losses are present. The vessel body is accompanied by a tall, flaring lid decorated with matching polychrome banding.

**Fig. 1.** *Jar (Wine Jar of Menedjem)*, New Kingdom, Late Dynasty 18–Dynasty 19, 1353–1190 BCE. Ceramic, painted; H. 93.5 cm. Penn Museum, Philadelphia, acc. no. E14368A. Image © Penn Museum.

**Iconography** The exterior is organised into alternating bands of plain and floral ornament in blue with red and black outlining (Fig.1). The floral element can be identified as an open lotus motif, which is a symbol of regeneration.[1] In addition to the decorative program, the surface bears a hieroglyphic inscription in ink which reads "Hamu wine for the Osiris Menedjem," identifying both the contents and the deceased recipient. Here, "Hamu" refers to the winemaking region of the Nile Delta. [2]

The formulaic reference to "Osiris + [name of person] situates the vessel within a funerary context, in which the deceased is

[1] Silverman, David P, Edward Brovarski, and Dallas Museum of Art. *Searching for Ancient Egypt : Art, Architecture, and Artifacts from the University of Pennsylvania Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology*. Dallas Museum of Art, 1997.
[2] Ibid.

assimilated to Osiris and provisioned with offerings for the afterlife.[3]

**Fig. 2.** Comparison of New Kingdom Egyptian wine jars from the funerary assemblage of Menedjem. Left: *Wine Jar*, 1539–1292 BCE, Penn Museum, Philadelphia, acc. no. E14369A–B. Centre: *Wine Jar*, 1353–1190 BCE, Penn Museum, Philadelphia, acc. no. E14368A–B. Right: *Wine Jar*, 1340–1300 BCE, British Museum, London, acc. no. EA59774. Images © Penn Museum;© The Trustees of the British Museum.

**Attribution & Dating** The vessel is dated to Late Dynasty 18-Dynasty 19 (1353-1190 BCE) on the basis of shape, pigment, and decorative typology by Silverman & Brovarski.[4] The elongated Ḥs-vase form and polychrome banding using cobalt-derived blue pigment are characteristic of New Kingdom ceramic production, and the shape and uniform firing reflect the technical proficiency of ceramic makers of the period.[5] The vessel formed part of a funerary assemblage belonging to a woman of high status named Menedjem, whose burial included two pairs of wine jars; companion vessels are held at the British Museum (EA59774, EA59775) and the Penn Museum (E14369A-B; see Fig. 2). The consistency of shape, decoration, and inscription across the three vessels supports a shared workshop origin, though the slightly divergent production date ranges assigned by each institution prevents a more precise attribution. No individual potter or workshop attribution is possible.

[3] Guasch-Jane, Maria Rosa. "The Meaning of Wine in Egyptian Tombs: The Three Amphorae from Tutankhamun's Burial Chamber." *Antiquity* (Cambridge, UK) 85, no. 329 (2011): 851–58. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003598X00068356.

[4] Silverman, David P, Edward Brovarski, and Dallas Museum of Art. *Searching for Ancient Egypt : Art, Architecture, and Artifacts from the University of Pennsylvania Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology*. Dallas Museum of Art, 1997.

[5] Ibid.

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British Museum, "wine-jar," museum no. EA59774, *British Museum Collection Online*, accessed April 3, 2026, https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/Y_EA59774.

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